

105

Standing Order No.235

Subject: - Theft of motor vehicles; action regarding.

It has been experienced that considerable confusion is caused in locating stolen vehicles and restoring the same to their owners due to belated dissemination of information regarding details of such vehicles, to police stations. As soon as theft of a car, scooter or motor-cycle is reported to the police, its details should be communicated by the Police Control Room to all Police Stations and Police Posts, who, in turn, would direct all officers and men to keep a sharp look-out for the vehicle, particularly in areas where stolen vehicles might have been found abandoned in the past. Special look-out for such Stolen cars/vehicles should be kept opposite tyre-markets, dealers in second hand parts, motor garages and on foot-paths and lonely places. All officers and men should be instructed that if they come across any car parked in any such place and wheels or tyres are found missing, they should watch it for some time, and if one approaches it, information about it should be given to the Police Control Room and the Police Station immediately, and identity of car/vehicle should be established with utmost speed. If it is found to be stolen, the investigating officer should be asked to take all necessary steps to examine the vehicle for scientific clues like, finger prints, etc. In short the following drill shall be followed in such cases:-

1. To register a case immediately and inform the control room simultaneously giving registration number, make, colours, engine and chassis number, etc. of the stolen vehicle.
2. To send wireless messages to all the SHOs in the capital and to all the Superintendents/Deputy Commissioners of Police in India.
3. To send immediate information on the prescribed proforma about the particulars of the stolen vehicle to CRO.
4. If the engine and chassis number are provided by the Complainant later on, information of the same should be sent to CRO and to all those to whom the earlier wireless messages were sent.

107

5. Known motor vehicle thieves should be interrogated in the case.
6. If the stolen vehicle is found abandoned, it should not be removed from that place till the Crime Team, CFSL experts inspect it for clues like finger prints of the culprits, etc, on some part of the vehicle. Articles lying in the abandoned vehicle like bottles and glasses should also not be disturbed till these are examined by the experts. Meanwhile the vehicle should be kept under watch and identity of persons approaching it established.
- 7 All articles found in the vehicle should be taken into possession through a recovery memo and deposited in the Malkhana.
- 8 Information about the stolen vehicle having been found abandoned must be sent to all concerned i.e. CRO and to all those to whom wireless messages were sent earlier including the Control Room for discontinuing the search. This important aspect must not be ignored.
9. If any stolen vehicle is found in the area of a particular Police station, it must be guarded and information sent to the Control Room, Crime Team and to all the stations in the Capital. If the vehicle bears ~~registration number of some other~~ State/District, wireless message should be sent to the concerned authorities giving the registration, engine and chassis number, make and colours of the vehicle. If the vehicle is to be brought to the police station, the vehicle as well as any articles found therein should not be disturbed or mishandled. The vehicle should be taken into possession through a recovery memo alongwith all the articles found in it.
- 10 The SHO should ensure that information about the stolen vehicle found in his jurisdiction reaches the CRO as in some cases, a vehicle found abandoned in the area of a police station and stolen from the area of the adjoining police station, remains un-connected for a long time.
11. The registration of a case in respect of theft of a motor vehicle should not be delayed as sometimes it leads to serious consequences such as commission of a highway robbery or dacoity by the occupants of the vehicle bearing the same registration (original)

number. It has been noticed that in some cases the duty officers put off the registration of the case unnecessarily by telling the complainant to be on the look out for the vehicle in the adjoining areas and then come again. This should never be done.

12. When a stolen vehicle is found abandoned and is taken into possession, the missing parts such as wheels, head lights, battery, etc, should be clearly mentioned in the seizure memo.

13. If the stolen vehicle is found abandoned in some other state/district, the complainant should not be asked to bear the expenses to be incurred in connection with the bringing of the vehicle from there. The expenses are met by the state through judicial bills.

14. If a vehicle found abandoned appears to have met with an accident, it should be photographed properly from different angles. All the damages should be mentioned in the seizure memo.

15. It must be ensured that there is no pilferage of accessories from the recovered vehicle. The recovered vehicles should be parked in the Police Station and in case it is not possible, a guard may be posted at least during the night hours. In order to check pilferage from within the Police Station, the following remedial measures are suggested:-

- a. IO of the case should mention in greater detail different parts, accessories in the seizure memo itself e.g. stereo, battery, stepany, tools, jack, radiators and other fancy accessories.
- b. MHC(M) should take charge of the vehicle according to the seizure memo and should mention all the details of the seizure memo in register No.19.
- c. MHC(M) and his assistant should conduct random checks till the release of the vehicle.
- d. While releasing such vehicle on 'Superdari' to the rightful owners, MHC(M) should deliver the

(11)

possession in accordance with the details listed in the seizure memo and register No.19.

16. The vehicle should be returned to the registered owner on 'Superdari' immediately on the order of the court.
 17. Notorious workshops which change the colours of stolen vehicles in a short time must be raided in immediately. The police station staff should have a list of such workshops and keep an eye on them. With the change of colours and registration number, detection becomes difficult.
 18. Traps should be intelligently laid at places from where motor vehicles are frequently stolen.
 19. Watch must be kept on the known receiver of stolen motor vehicles and motor parts who prompt theft of motor vehicles.
 20. In the event of theft of a motor vehicle, the PCR should pass on the information to all District Control Rooms and to the wireless cabins located at each police station.
 21. The SHO/DO should immediately write the information about the stolen vehicle on the Notice Board.
-
22. The patrolling parties should know the details of the stolen vehicles and should look for it in the area.
 23. Motor vehicle owners must be advised (through cinema slides, newspapers, TV, etc.) to park vehicles at the parking places meant for the purpose rather than leaving them unattended.
 24. The local police must request the local bodies federation of businessmen and residents of the area to arrange manning of parking place to avoid motor vehicles thefts.
 25. The Control Room should maintain a running list of stolen motor cars, scooters and motor-cycles showing their recoveries also.
 26. Since the Traffic Police have been provided with wireless fitted Motor Cycles they should also be informed about the theft of cars/vehicles for necessary action. Each upper and lower subordinates who locates the stolen or abandoned car/vehicle

should be rewarded suitably to encourage the patrolling staff and to make them more alert for ensuring quicker recovery.

27. Each Distt. Control Room will also alert their wireless fitted motor cycle riders to look for the stolen vehicle.
28. On receipt of a report of theft of a motor-car scooter or motor-cycle, the Control Room should immediately instruct all the patrol cars to keep a sharp look-out for the stolen motor vehicle. All the known details of the vehicle should be conveyed to all such patrol cars immediately. Each patrol car should carry a running list of cars stolen in the last, 30 days which remain unrecovered.
29. The tendency of sending car theft cases untraced, when it is prima facie premature needs to be avoided. The final reports in such cases should be sent after and when all measures have been exhausted.
30. DCsP Distt./Crime & Railways/IGI Airport shall send a monthly statement regarding stolen and recovered vehicles to Secretary, Transport Govt. of GNCT of Delhi latest by 5th of succeeding months.

This supersedes previous S.O.No.235 issued vide this Hdqrs.No.11600-800/C& T, AC-III dated 17.02.89.


(YUDHBIR SINGH DADWAL) SPL.CP/ADMN.,
for COMMISSIONER OF POLICE: DELHI.

No. 25615-714/C& T, AC-III ~~dated~~, Delhi the 25/05/06

Copy to:-

1. ALL Spl.Cs.P., Delhi/New Delhi.
2. All Jt. CsP & Addl.CsP., Delhi/New Delhi.
3. All DCsP of Distt./units including FRRO, Delhi/New Delhi.
4. Principal/PTC, Jharoda Kalan, New Delhi with 10 spare copies.
5. DCP/HQ and DCP/HQ(Estt.), Delhi.
6. ACsP/HQ (P), (CB), (G), (C&T) and (IT).
7. SO/PA to CP/Delhi.
8. All Inspectors, PHQ including Acctt./PHQ.
9. HAR/PHQ with 5 spare copies.